Zaheer bowls another maiden to Morné. The total is 0–0 after three overs, and I am starting to become aware of a knot in my stomach, an ache of anxiety deep within me.

RP Singh is bowling the fourth over. I am facing and his first delivery swings away far down leg side. MS Dhoni parries the ball towards fine leg and, as the umpire signals a wide, we take the single. I reach the non-striker's end and breathe deeply. This is no fun at all but, at last, we're off the mark at two runs for no wicket.

Next ball, RP bowls short of a length on leg stump and Morné fends the ball towards midwicket. There is nobody there, so I call for the single and start running … but the ball hasn't travelled far and RP is following through and fielding it himself. Morné sees the danger and shouts, 'No', sending me back. I turn and dash back to the non-striker's end but RP throws the ball to Dravid, who takes off the bails. I dive and stretch … and I'm out.

AB de Villiers run out 0 (14m, 6b, 0x4, 0x6) SR: 0.00

Worst of all, as I walk slowly back to the pavilion, getting out almost feels like a relief.

'Jakes, do you have a moment to speak?'

'Sure.'

So we spoke, and spoke, and spoke about my general concerns, about my batting technique, about getting the distribution of my weight correct so I didn't lose balance; and that afternoon we went to the nets, just the two of us, to put into practice what we had discussed – and we went again the next day, and the day after that.

Confidence slowly returned and, after scoring 63 and 107 in ODIs against Zimbabwe, I managed to make 77, 45 and 103 not out in consecutive innings against Pakistan. Cricket quickly seemed fun again but I will always remember that, in one of my darkest hours, Jacques Kallis had